

CorelDRAW 11

All the vector power you need!

Over the years, Corel has gradually evolved into an extremely powerful vector based illustration software. Although version 11 isn't essentially different from its predecessor, it does include new tools and enhancements that lend the programs a little more power and make them easy to use. Adobe Illustrator is the only rival to CorelDRAW in the market as of now, but Corel scores as an illustration program because of its powerful drawing tools and brilliant interface. The program makes it easy to create your own toolbars, menus and macros, then save that customised work space for specific tasks. For example, if you make lots of graphs, you can create an interface that puts all the important graph tools within easy reach.

CorelDRAW's cross-platform support and vast range of import/export filters are pretty impressive. The filters let you port files to and from other design programs, including Photoshop, Illustrator and Visio. When exporting a file to Photoshop, the layers remained intact.

A new set of 'Three point' drawing tools has been added to version 11, viz. 3-Point Ellipse, 3-Point Rectangle and 3-Point Curve tools, which enable users to

create and position angled or slanted shapes using very few mouse clicks. The New Poly-line and improved Pen tools also simplify the process of drawing curved and straight lines, making it a breeze even for first time users. Shaping has also been greatly



enhanced in this version, with new menu items including Simplify, Front Minus Back, Back Minus Front joining Weld, Trim and Intersect. Each of these tools gives you more control over the shape and placement of the objects in your document, thereby giving you more flexibility. It also gives you four different options to create a single closed path from multiple paths with either straight lines or curves, thereby helping to preserve the appearance of objects while creating them quickly. The Barcode Wizard makes it easy for you to make your own personalised barcodes.

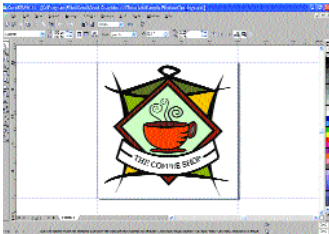
Although version 11 claims to have added a feature that lets you copy text from elsewhere and

paste it without losing the font and formatting, when we tried to copy text from a Web page, the formatting, as well as the font size was lost. However, you can convert paragraph text to curves and then apply effects such as drop shadows, without losing any formatting. Smudge and Roughen brushes have also been added to allow users to edit the curves of an object to give a wavy look. Unfortunately, these tools aren't as effective as those featured in Adobe Illustrator 10.

Just like the initial versions of Macromedia Flash, version 11 has 'symbols' that allow you to save your objects in the form of symbols and add them to the central library to be used later. This feature is a boon for artists who need to import images to reuse them. You can drag and drop a symbol into any document as many times as you want. Earlier, if you wanted to reuse objects such as arrows or call-out boxes, you had to save each image to a new file, then copy and paste this into your illustration. Symbols are faster and easier to use and don't significantly bloat file size.

Bundled with the drawing program is a revamped Web graphic and animation program called RAVE. This program lets you create interactive rollovers and generate 3D vector extrusions that add depth to your animations. If you find it difficult to create vector-based animations in

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CorelDRAW 11 has a user-friendly interface and sports the new XP-inspired look

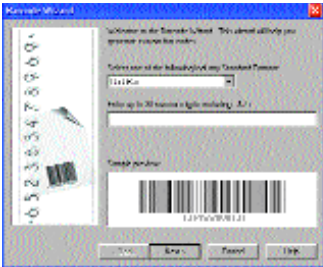
high-end software such as Macromedia Flash, you can easily create them here. But make no mistake, RAVE is not a true professional animation software and will need to ramp up quite a bit before it can compete head on with Flash.

With its fantastic drawing tools such as pressure-sensitive brushes, excellent filters that let you seamlessly import and export more than a hundred file formats and a user-friendly and customisable interface, CorelDRAW 11 is a great tool for artists. Even with all the fancy new features, CorelDRAW remains easy to use for novices and professionals alike. The incorporation of a few new tools and the enhancement of already existing ones speed up productivity as compared to the previous releases. But if you are already accustomed to using version 10, the new release does not give you enough reasons to upgrade.

SPECIFICATIONS

System Requirements:
Pentium II class processor,
200 MB disk space, 64 MB
RAM, monitor supporting resolution of 1024x768

CorelDRAW 11		B+
Performance	>>>>>	
Ease of use	>>>>>	
Value for money	>>>>>	
Features	>>>>>	
OVERALL	>>>>>	



The Barcode Wizard, a cool addition, helps you create and edit barcodes